
Service Insight Note

GB Imbalance & System Price Monitoring

Q4 2025 | Historical analytical review | Prepared 9 September 2026

ANALYTICAL QUESTION

Which unusual Settlement Periods merit investigation, and what does the available evidence establish before any escalation?

DATA / SOURCE

Official Elexon Insights API: 2025-10-01 to 2025-12-31. Latest settlement-run price/NIV snapshot retrieved 2026-09-09 at 16:32 UTC; detailed summary and bid/offer stacks for three selected periods. [1]

SERVICE / DATA STATUS

DERIVED: 4,418/4,418 expected periods (100%); 0 core validation exceptions. Includes 50 periods on 26 October. These checks establish snapshot coverage and validity, **not live service availability**.

KEY FINDINGS

DERIVED: Mean price GBP 75.72/MWh; median GBP 74.705/MWh. **FLAG:** 130 distinct periods (92 price-tail; 45 large-|NIV|; 7 overlap). Full-window thresholds: price at/below -11.22 or at/above 153.8997 GBP/MWh; |NIV| at/above 876.0417 MWh (display-rounded). These are review flags, not incidents.

MATERIAL EXCEPTION

OBSERVED: 2025-10-13 SP26: price GBP 487.00/MWh; NIV +184.92 MWh. **DERIVED:** quarter-high price; short system. Its |NIV| percentile rank is only 58.2%: the largest price and imbalance are different cases.

WHAT IS KNOWN

DERIVED: 3 retained offer-stack rows reconstruct GBP 487.00/MWh from loss-adjusted cost/volume plus the source adjuster. Stack and summary creation times agree. All three selected cases reconcile to penny precision; this supports the published calculation, not its underlying cause. [1, 2]

WHAT IS NOT ESTABLISHED

Why the balancing actions were needed; demand or generation causality; any service incident. **HYPOTHESIS:** action prices may explain price severity better than NIV magnitude alone. This is not a confirmed causal finding.

RECOMMENDED NEXT CHECKS

Confirm calculation vintages; review why retained actions were accepted using official action-level evidence, then targeted demand/generation context. Record evidence and an owner before escalation. Investigate official incident history if a data-control exception emerges.

LIMITATIONS

One quarter, one retrieval vintage; retrospective percentile screening with inclusive ties, not BSC limits or a predictive detector. Different datasets can carry different vintages despite price agreement. Power BI runtime and interactions remain unverified; no deployment is claimed.

[1] Elexon API catalogue; immutable snapshots and calculations: repository SOURCES.md / METHODOLOGY.md.

[2] Elexon imbalance pricing guidance. Independent portfolio project; not affiliated with or endorsed by Elexon.